

note sheets for approval, from table to table, the employees used the tool. Pop-up alert messages acknowledged the receipt of the e-document.

All letters received from external agencies are now scanned and converted into electronic documents, which are then added to the repository on the LAN. This system enables a user to check the status of a file, at any stage. More importantly, delays are minimised as the files can be traced over the LAN—employees can now know which officer has kept the file pending.

“The biggest advantage of e-Administration is that it enables us to view, at any stage, the status of pending file. The details are available on a central server and can be accessed by anyone. This way, workflow is simplified,” says Appuswamy.

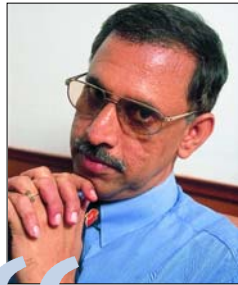
LL2B's e-Administration tool not only effects a dramatic reduction of stationery usage, and time taken to process documents, it also serves to introduce transparency in the working of any organisation.

ELCOT employees also took to the system rather well. Says Appuswamy, “Our employees became more and more comfortable with using the tool as the trials progressed. It's quite user-friendly and doesn't require a lot of technical expertise. I myself began using the system without any formal training, and have been using it successfully for eight months now.”

The Accolades Have Been Coming

At the 7th National e-Gov conference held in Chennai in November 2003, ELCOT received a merit citation award from the Government of India, for implementation of e-Administration as a tool for e-Governance.

The Industrial Guidance Bureau of the Government of Pondicherry has implemented an integrated e-Platform, a quickly customised solution of 'e-Administration', to automate the activities of the Directorate of Industries and Commerce. Being attempted for the first time in India, 21 departments—including municipi-



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palities and panchayats are connected on a simple dial-up. The central repository server is located at the District Industries Centre, Pondicherry. All this forms a dedicated electronic network, that allows the Government to grant permission, for example to set up an industry; it can also help a manufacturing unit obtain a licence to commence production, among other things.

Says Krishnan, “This will save a lot of time, effort and cost to industrialists and citizens as well as officials of various departments. As opposed to submitting 10 copies of documents in the manual system, the electronic system, only needs one signed copy to be submitted, thereby helping save paper. It can help to fuel investment in the State and generate employment for local people.”

Various Central and State Government departments and undertakings including the Andhra Pradesh Technology Services, the Governments of West Bengal, Orissa, Manipur, Goa

e-Administration can transparently prioritise a task

etc. State Bank of India, the Canadian Consulate in Chennai, British Trade Office (Bangalore), Ministry of Industrial Development, Malaysia and the State of Sarawak, Malaysia have shown interest in implementing e-Administration.

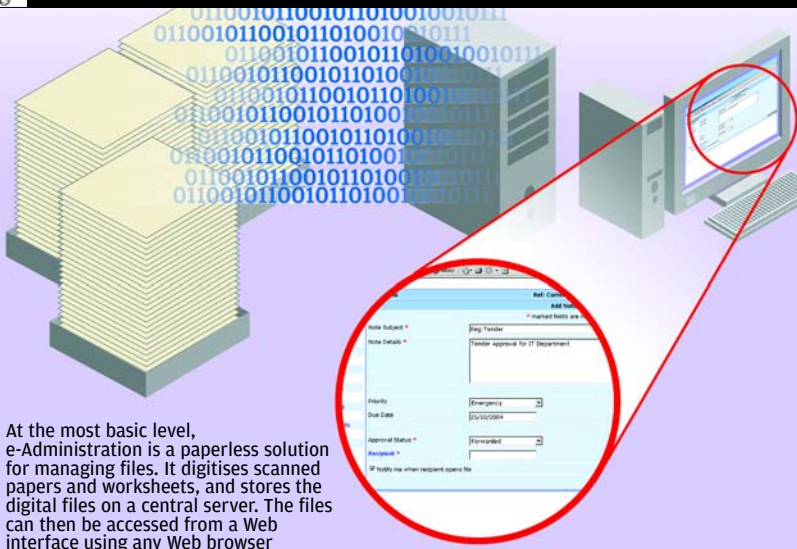
Far from resting on their laurels, LL2B plans to reach out to the various Government Departments as well as corporates, SMEs and NGOs by offering the basic solution for free and charging only for customisation, installation, training, annual maintenance and upgrade support, either directly or through ELCOT, with whom LL2B has a marketing tie-up. This is expected to benefit Governments in India and the developing world, by saving on e-Governance expenditure. “We are currently holding discussions with the Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority and The Tamil Nadu Dr. MGR Medical University, to implement 'e-Administration' in their offices or institutions across the city,” says Krishnan.

ELCOT has received the mandate from the Tamil Nadu Government, to implement LL2B's solution in as many offices as possible in the state, with a view to reduce as many bottlenecks as possible in the administrative machinery.

While it's naïve to believe that paperless office solutions like LL2B's, may just be the panacea for our red-tape ridden bureaucracy, it certainly is a step in the right direction. ■

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? How e-Administration works



At the most basic level, e-Administration is a paperless solution for managing files. It digitises scanned papers and worksheets, and stores the digital files on a central server. The files can then be accessed from a Web interface using any Web browser